

FUNCTION VS METHOD

A simple explanation for beginners
in programming.



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HARDIK VAGHELA

WHAT IS A FUNCTION?

A function is a block of reusable code that performs a specific task.

It can exist independently—outside of any object or class.

Example (JavaScript):



```
1  function add(a, b) {  
2      return a + b;  
3  }
```



KEY TRAITS OF A FUNCTION

- Independent — not tied to an object
- Can be called directly
- Works with input (parameters)
- Returns an output (value)

HOW FUNCTIONS ARE CALLED

You call a function by its name:



```
1 add(5, 3);
```



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WHAT IS A METHOD?

A method is a function that belongs to an object or class.

It works on data stored inside that object.

Example (JavaScript):



```
1  const user = {  
2    name: "Hardik",  
3    greet() {  
4      return `Hello, ${this.name}`;  
5    }  
6  };
```



KEY TRAITS OF A FUNCTION

- Always attached to an object/class
- Uses this to access internal values
- Represents behavior or actions of that object
- Called using dot notation

HOW METHODS ARE CALLED

You call a method using the object/class it's part of:



```
1 user.greet();
```



REAL-LIFE ANALOGY

Function:

A tool you can pick up and use anywhere.

Method:

A tool built inside a machine; it works only within that machine.



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PROFESSIONAL COMPARISON

Function:

A function stands alone and is not connected to any object or class. It cannot access object-specific data and is invoked directly using its name, such as `calculateTotal()`. Functions are best suited for general-purpose operations that work independently of object context.



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PROFESSIONAL COMPARISON

Method:

A method, on the other hand, is always part of an object or class. It can access internal data through this, making it tightly connected to the object's state. Methods are invoked using the object they belong to, such as `user.getName()`, and they represent the behavior or actions of that object.



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SUMMARY SLIDE

- Function → Independent piece of code
- Method → Function inside an object/class
- All methods are functions, but not all functions are methods
- Methods represent object behavior
- Functions are general-purpose utilities



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